FOOD SAFETY & HYGIENE POLICY

Ensuring Clean, Safe, and Responsible Food Handling

POLICY PURPOSE & REGULATORY CONTEXT

CoffeeNChill is committed to the clean, safe preparation and service of all food and beverages.

All food-handling staff must follow our hygiene and safety procedures at all times.

South African R638 defines a food handler as a person in direct contact with food, equipment, utensils, or food-contact surfaces.

SOURCE

South African Government R638 PDF
https://www.gov.za/documents/regulations-r638

HAND HYGIENE
WHEN AND HOW

WASH YOUR HANDS:

Before handling or preparing food

After using the toilet or handling waste

After touching contaminated surfaces or raw food

Before handling ready-to-eat food

Whenever hands become dirty

WHO recommends frequent handwashing during food prep and after toilet use.

FoodSafety.gov advises washing with soap and water for at least 20 seconds.

Personal Hygiene Requirements

Wear clean work clothing

Keep hair controlled and nails clean

Cover cuts or wounds appropriately

Avoid unnecessary touching of food

Minimise jewellery when handling food

Wash hands regularly throughout shift

Good hygiene is part of our professional responsibility.

STAFF ILLNESS REPORTING

If you are unwell, report it. Do not handle food or beverages when you could contaminate them.

REPORT SYMPTOMS SUCH AS:

Vomiting
Diarrhoea
Fever
Infected wounds or skin lesions

WHO advises **immediate reporting** of fever, diarrhea, vomiting, or visible infected skin lesions to your employer.

YOUR ACTION PROTECTS CUSTOMERS AND COLLEAGUES

CROSS-CONTAMINATION - RISKS AND PREVENTION

Cross-contamination is the accidental transfer of harmful microorganisms or allergens between foods, surfaces, or objects.

RISKS

Raw chicken prepared on the same knife as ready-to-eat food

Dirty cutting board used for sandwiches

Touching ready-to-eat food after handling raw ingredients

PREVENTION

Keep raw and ready-to-eat foods separate

Clean equipment between uses

Wash hands properly

Use the right utensils

Store food correctly

SOURCE
South African Government R638

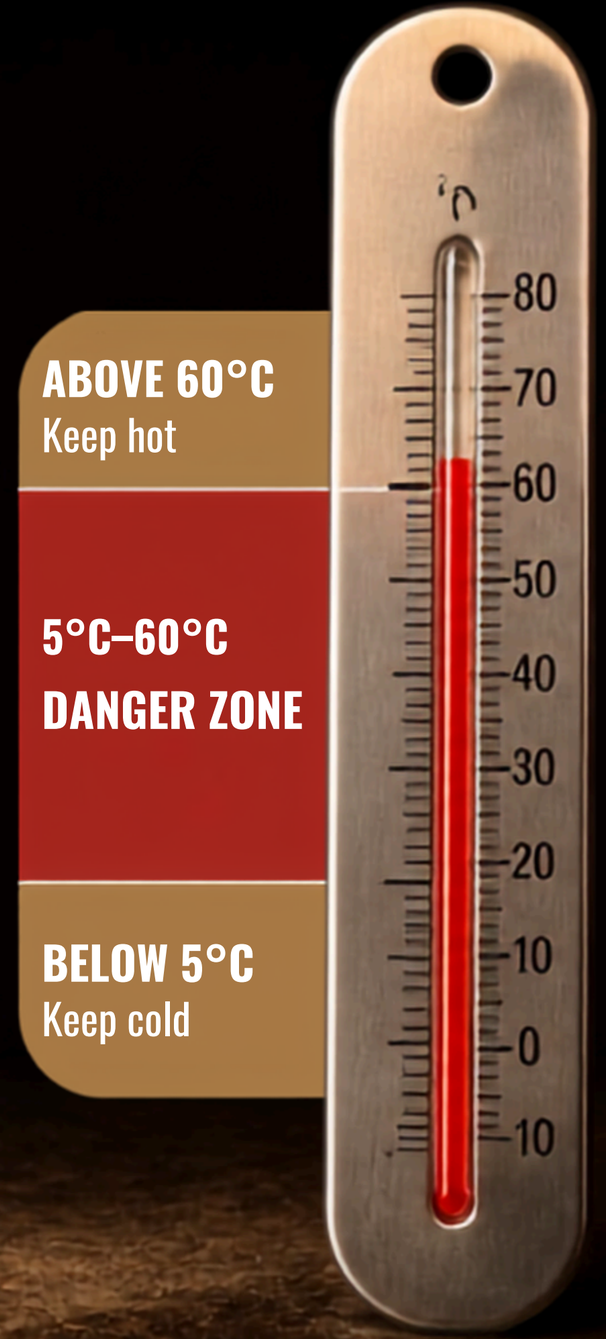
FOOD TEMPERATURE SAFETY

5°C–60°C
Danger zone where bacteria grow fastest

Below 5°C
Refrigerate perishable food

Above 60°C
Hold cooked food hot during service

Keep cold food cold
Keep hot food hot and don’t leave perishable food out unnecessarily



Pre-Service
Food Safety Checklist

Food looks acceptable and smells normal

Packaging intact and product within use-by date

Food stored correctly

Preparation area clean and hygienic

Correct utensils selected and allergens considered

Thorough Checks Before Service
Protect Our Customers and Our Business.

Stop - Isolate - Report - Record Procedure

Act fast if you suspect food contamination. Follow these steps in order.

1
Stop
Immediately stop using the affected food.

→

2
Isolate
Keep it separate from other food items.

→

3
Report
Inform the manager or person responsible.

→

4
Record
Document the incident and actions taken.

A quick response protects our customers and safeguards our reputation.

THANK YOU
AND FURTHER RESOURCES

Thank you for prioritizing food safety at CoffeeNChill.

KEY REFERENCES

South African Government R638 PDF

WHO Five Keys to Safer Food poster

FoodSafety.gov 4 Steps to Food Safety

WHO Salmonella fact sheet

We welcome your questions and are committed to ongoing learning for safety excellence.